

Veteran Education & GI Bill

Your service can pay for college, training, certifications — even for your family. Below is how to use your education benefits. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

The GI Bill can cover tuition, housing, and books, and unused benefits can sometimes transfer to a spouse or child. Apply free on VA.gov — never pay a service to “process” your education benefits.

1 Use Your GI Bill

Pay for school or training, often with a housing allowance.

☐ Post-9/11 GI Bill

Covers tuition, a monthly housing allowance, and a books stipend for eligible veterans.

→ www.va.gov/education/about-gi-bill-benefits/post-9-11

☐ Compare GI Bill Benefits

See which GI Bill program fits and what each school offers.

→ www.va.gov/education/gi-bill-comparison-tool

2 Beyond a Traditional Degree

Benefits cover many paths, not just college.

☐ Apprenticeships & On-the-Job Training

Earn while you train, using GI Bill benefits. See the Apprenticeships guide.

→ www.va.gov/education/about-gi-bill-benefits/how-to-use-benefits/on-the-job-training-apprenticeships

☐ Vocational Rehabilitation (VR&E / Chapter 31)

Free training, education, and job help for veterans with service-connected disabilities.

→ www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation

3 Extra Money for School

Programs that add to your benefits.

☐ Yellow Ribbon Program

Helps cover tuition above the GI Bill cap at participating schools.

→ www.va.gov/education/about-gi-bill-benefits/post-9-11/yellow-ribbon-program

☐ VetSuccess on Campus

Free on-campus support to help veterans succeed in school.

→ www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation/programs/vetsuccess-on-campus

4 Benefits for Your Family

Your education benefits can help your loved ones too.

☐ Transfer GI Bill to Family

Eligible service members can transfer unused benefits to a spouse or children.

→ www.va.gov/education/transfer-post-9-11-gi-bill-benefits

☐ Survivors' & Dependents' Education (DEA / Fry)

Education benefits for families of veterans who died or are permanently disabled.

→ www.va.gov/education/survivor-dependent-benefits

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of for-profit schools that aggressively recruit veterans for their GI Bill money — check graduation and job rates with the GI Bill Comparison Tool, and prefer accredited public colleges.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Use the free GI Bill Comparison Tool before enrolling — it shows your housing allowance and how much each school will actually cost you, so your benefits stretch further.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For schools, training, and a VSO near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
